



# The Marathon Digest

## The PHU MOLO MARATHON LAUNCH



PEACE



EDUCATION



COMMUNITY



The Proposed Hekima University (PHU) proudly marked a major milestone with the successful official launch of the PHU Molo Marathon held on Friday, 8th May 2026 at Baraka College in Molo. The launch event brought together a vibrant and diverse gathering of stakeholders, community members, institutions, leaders, athletes and partners, all united by a shared vision of education, community empowerment, health and social transformation.

The launch served not only as the unveiling of what promises to become one of the most impactful sporting and community events in Nakuru County, but also as a strong statement of the growing support and goodwill towards the vision of the Proposed Hekima University. With an impressive attendance of approximately 200 participants representing different demographics and sectors of society,

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### Warm Reception from the Community

One of the most remarkable highlights of the launch was the overwhelmingly positive reception from the local community. From the moment preparations began, the people of Molo embraced the PHU Molo Marathon with excitement, optimism and a genuine spirit of partnership. The launch attracted participation and support from local residents, youth groups, religious institutions, schools, educational leaders, business representatives and community organizations who all expressed their enthusiasm for the marathon and the broader vision behind the Proposed Hekima University.



The local business community demonstrated immense goodwill and openness towards collaboration, recognizing the marathon as a transformative initiative capable of stimulating economic activity, promoting tourism and positioning Molo as a destination for sports, education and community development. Educational institutions within Molo and across Nakuru County also showed great interest and support for the initiative. Their presence reflected a shared commitment towards empowering young people through education, mentorship, sports and holistic development.

Religious institutions equally played a major role in supporting and encouraging the initiative. Their participation underscored the shared values of service, community development, ethical leadership and human dignity that continue to define the mission and vision of the Proposed Hekima University.

### Strong Government and Institutional Representation

The successful launch was further strengthened by the presence and participation of key leaders and representatives from various sectors. The Office of the Governor of Nakuru County and the Office of the CECM for Education Nakuru County, were represented by Mr. Victor Mwandale, demonstrating the County Government's recognition of the significance and potential impact of the PHU Molo Marathon. Speaking at the function Mr. Mwandale emphasized the importance of the establishment of PHU in Nakuru county saying this will further elevate Molo and Nakuru County as an education destination and also add significant value to the region.

He confirmed Her Excellency's commitment in flagging off the Marathon and also rendering her unreserved support to making the event a great success. Additionally, the launch attracted top leadership from Athletics Kenya North Rift Region, whose participation gave immense credibility and encouragement to the marathon initiative. Their involvement reflected confidence in the organizational vision and the potential for the PHU Molo Marathon to grow into a major sporting event within the region and beyond. The support and encouragement from athletics leadership also inspired participants and stakeholders, further strengthening the event's position as a professionally envisioned and community-driven initiative. Religious institutions equally played a major role in supporting and encouraging the initiative. Their participation underscored the shared values of service, community development, ethical leadership and human dignity that continue to define the mission and vision of the Proposed Hekima University.



### Dr. Elias Mokua Leadership Remarks and Institutional Vision

Speaking during the launch, Dr. Elias Mokua, the Proposed Vice Chancellor of the Proposed Hekima University (PHU), shared the wider vision of what the University seeks to achieve in transforming the local community through education, leadership formation and economic empowerment. Dr. Mokua emphasized that the establishment of the university in Molo will significantly elevate the area and Nakuru County at large to international standards. He noted that PHU, being the first Jesuit institution in the wider Eastern African region, is uniquely positioned to attract students from across several African countries as well as from other parts of the world.

He further highlighted that the university's presence will create long-term opportunities for local communities through job creation, business growth, infrastructural development and increased int'l engagement within the region. His remarks strongly resonated with attendees and further reinforced the significance of the PHU Molo Marathon as a platform that supports a much larger vision of educational excellence, social transformation and sustainable community impact.

The PHU Molo Marathon is more than a sporting event. It represents a broader movement towards community engagement, education support, youth empowerment, wellness and sustainable social impact. The marathon forms part of the wider efforts surrounding the establishment and growth of the Proposed Hekima University, an upcoming institution of higher learning founded under the auspices of the Society of Jesus (Jesuits), in collaboration with the Catholic Church. Globally, Jesuit institutions are widely recognized for their commitment to academic excellence, ethical leadership, social justice and the holistic development of individuals and communities.

The PHU Molo Marathon embodies these values by bringing people together around a cause that promotes education, unity, healthy living and opportunity creation. The launch event clearly demonstrated that the PHU vision resonates strongly with communities across Molo and Nakuru County. There was visible excitement about the long-term benefits the university and the marathon can bring to the region through educational opportunities, economic growth, talent development and community transformation.

### Energy, Excitement and Community Spirit

The atmosphere at Baraka College throughout the launch was filled with excitement, positivity and anticipation. Participants engaged enthusiastically in the activities of the day, networking and sharing ideas about the future of the marathon and the Proposed Hekima University. The event showcased a rich mix of attendees from different age groups, professions and backgrounds, reflecting the inclusive nature of the initiative. Youth, educators, athletes, clergy, business leaders, government representatives and community members all interacted in a spirit of unity and collaboration.



The route for the marathon was officially marked and preparations for the main event are now well underway. Registration activities have also commenced successfully, with growing interest from participants and supporters. The successful launch has created significant momentum and confidence as the organizing team continues preparations for what is expected to become one of the biggest community and sporting events in Nakuru County.



### Gratitude to All Stakeholders

The Proposed Hekima University extends heartfelt appreciation to every individual, institution and organization that contributed towards the success of the launch.

### Special appreciation goes to:

- The local community of Molo for the warm reception and support.
- Religious institutions for their encouragement and partnership.
- Educational institutions and leaders for embracing the vision.
- The business community for their openness towards collaboration.
- The County Government representatives for honoring the event.
- The CECM for Education for the support and presence.
- Athletics Kenya North Rift Region leadership for their encouragement and participation.
- Baraka College for hosting the successful launch.
- The organizing teams, volunteers and partners who worked tirelessly to ensure the event's success.



The overwhelming goodwill demonstrated during the launch is a clear indication that the PHU Molo Marathon has already begun building strong partnerships and meaningful community ownership.

### Looking Ahead

The successful launch of the PHU Molo Marathon marks the beginning of an exciting journey. With the strong foundation established through community support, institutional goodwill and stakeholder engagement, the future of the marathon looks exceptionally bright.

As preparations continue towards the main marathon event, the Proposed Hekima University remains committed to building a platform that will positively impact lives through education, sports, mentorship and community development. The enthusiasm witnessed during the launch confirms that the PHU Molo Marathon is not merely an event, but a growing movement that has captured the imagination and support of the people of Molo and Nakuru County.

The countdown to the main marathon is officially on. Together, we move forward with hope, purpose and a shared commitment to transforming communities through education, sport and partnership.

The Proposed Hekima University Molo Marathon(PHU)

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